TIPS & TRICKS

How to delete containers that are not in use

We often create containers and forget to delete them. Deleting each container by ID becomes challenging when there are too many containers running on your Linux system. Instead, you can use the following simple command to delete all stopped containers:

```
$ docker rm $(docker ps -aq)
```

In the above command, the 'docker ps -aq' sub-command lists the IDs of all containers. We are running this command in the sub-shell; hence, all container IDs are passed to the 'docker rm' command, which deletes containers, one by one.

—Megha Malhari, malharimegha@gmail.com

Finding files, on the basis of their size

Linux comes with a very powerful command to search for files and folders. The command is 'find'.

GNU find searches the directory tree rooted at each given starting point by evaluating the given expression from left to right, according to the rules of precedence, until the outcome is known (the left hand side is false for *and* operations, true for *or* operations), at which point *find* moves on to the next file name. If no starting point is specified, '.' is assumed. It comes with many switches, which you can refer to in the man pages. Here is a tip to search all files that are more than 100MB. To find these, we will run the following command:

```
#find / -size +100M
```

Such commands are very handy when your disk is full.

—Kousik kousikster@gmail.com

Executing a command after shell logout or exit

When you execute a UNIX command in the background, and if you log out or exit the session, your process will get killed. You can avoid this by using *nohup*, which stands for 'no hang up'. This means you can execute the command after the session logout or exit.

The syntax for *nohup* is shown below:

```
$nohup command_with_parameters &
```

nohup is very useful in situations in which you want to run the command or shell-script that takes a longer time to complete. So, using *nohup* you don't need to be connected to session and wait for it to finish.

By default, *nohup* redirects the standard output to *nohup.out* and the standard error to the standard output, i.e., *nohup.out*, in the current directory. You can change the default redirect of *nohup* as follows:

```
nohup bash shell-script.sh > shell-script.log&
```

—Prashant Wakchaure, prashant.wakchaure@gmail.com

Opening the editor in the terminal, quickly

We often need to open the editor for text typing or programming. *vi*, *vim* and *emacs* have been used by developers for many years. The Linux system now has the nano/pico editor, which is used by many developers to code in the terminal itself. To open the nano editor quickly, you need to type the following shortcut key:

```
Ctrl-x-e
```

To close or come out of the editor, just press the following:

```
ctrl-x
```

—Tushar Kute, tushar@tusharkute.com

END

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The joy of using open source software is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in *OSFY* so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at *www.opensourceforu.com.* The sender of each published tip will get a T-shirt.